

Quebec teenager celebrates Ella's victory at World Dairy Expo

From: CBC World Mined: 2026-10-03 5 min read

A Canadian teenager and her favourite cow earned a major honour at the World Dairy Expo in Madison, Wisconsin, on Sunday. Alyson Doiron, a 16-year-old high school student from Cap-Santé, Quebec, celebrated when Ella won the top prize at the **International** Junior Holstein Show.

The five-year-old cow's full name is Arolene Dempsey Ella. Holstein refers to a breed of dairy **cattle**, the cows kept for milk production. At a **cattle** show, animals enter an **arena** to be judged in a competition.

Doiron cheered and cried as she received Ella's award. She described Ella as easy to work with and much loved. For Doiron, the result also demonstrated the strength of cow showing in her home province.

These contests can have consequences beyond a trophy. A major victory can increase an animal's value by tens of thousands of dollars, and its future **offspring** may become more valuable too.

Although the Expo attracts an **international** gathering, health and safety **regulations** limit its animal competitions to cows from Canadian and American farms. Canadian, American and Mexican flags hang above the judging **arena**.

Transporting cows to the event requires considerable effort. Brian Carscadden, the executive senior manager and part owner of Quebec dairy company Blondin Sires, said his team travelled more than 1,500 kilometres from St. Placide to Madison, bringing 25 cows in trailers.

The gathering happened against the background of a trade **dispute** between Canada and the United States. Carscadden said his business had not yet been affected and that the **dispute** rarely came up in conversations at the Expo. Some American visitors expressed frustration about trade policies and living costs.

The event brought Canadian and American farms together for competition, with Doiron and Ella celebrating their success.

Word Treasure

cattle -- Farm animals that include cows and bulls.

arena -- A space where a competition takes place.

offspring -- An animal's young.

regulations -- Official rules.

international -- Involving more than one country.

dispute -- A disagreement.

Background you need

Dairy cattle are cows kept for milk production.

At a cattle show, animals enter an arena to be judged.

Break it down

Opens with Doiron and Ella's Sunday award at the World Dairy Expo.

Explains dairy cattle and describes Doiron's reaction.

Describes the possible financial effects of a competition win.

Explains animal entry rules and the team's journey.

Places the gathering in the context of a trade dispute and returns to the competition.

Why it matters

Ella's win shows how farming competitions can matter to young participants and influence the value of animals and their offspring.

Test what you remember

1. On which day did Ella win the reported award?
 - (A) Saturday
 - (B) Monday
 - (C) Sunday
 - (D) Friday
2. What is Ella's full name?
 - (A) Arolene Dempsey Ella
 - (B) Arolene Dempsey Ellie
 - (C) Arolene Dempsey Eva
 - (D) Arolene Dempsey Emma
3. What did the win mean to Doiron beyond receiving an award?
 - (A) It showed Canada's strength in trailer building.
 - (B) It showed Wisconsin's strength in cow transport.
 - (C) It showed Quebec's strength in cow showing.
 - (D) It showed Madison's strength in milk selling.
4. What may happen after an animal wins a major competition?
 - (A) Its value and its offspring's value may rise.
 - (B) Its breed and its offspring's breed may change.
 - (C) Its age and its offspring's age may decrease.
 - (D) Its name and its offspring's name may shorten.
5. Which farms can supply animals for the Expo's competitions?
 - (A) Canadian and British farms
 - (B) Canadian and American farms
 - (C) Canadian and Mexican farms
 - (D) American and Mexican farms
6. What did Carscadden report about his business and the trade dispute?
 - (A) His business had stopped attending the Expo.
 - (B) His business had not yet been affected.
 - (C) His business had moved out of Quebec.
 - (D) His business had stopped transporting cows.

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: C 4: A 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Alyson Doiron: She described Ella as easy to work with and much loved, and saw the award as a sign of strong cow showing in Quebec.
2. Brian Carscadden: He said his business had not yet been affected by the trade dispute and that the subject rarely arose in conversations at the Expo.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):